

Payap University
The International College

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Department of English Communication Arts

**Creating Content, Building Audiences, Earning Income: Challenges and Opportunities for
Mon Content Creators on Facebook**

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Abstract

This study examines how Mon content creators use Facebook as a platform for content creation, audience building, and income generation. The research aims to explore content creation practices, analyze audience engagement strategies, and investigate the challenges and opportunities experienced by Mon creators in the digital environment. A mixed-method approach was employed, combining quantitative data from a structured questionnaire administered to 30 Mon content creators and qualitative data from semi-structured interviews with three selected participants.

The findings reveal that a large proportion of creators plan their content, follow trending topics, and prioritize audience interaction to improve visibility and engagement. Approximately 87% of respondents reported planning their content before posting, while 92% emphasized the importance of engagement for increasing reach. Although Facebook provides multiple income opportunities, including monetization tools and sponsorships, only about 40% of respondents considered their income stable. Key challenges include algorithm changes, competition, time constraints, financial costs, and negative feedback. At the same time, Facebook offers significant opportunities for cultural promotion, audience growth, skill development, and social influence.

The study concludes that Facebook plays a vital role in supporting Mon content creators as digital entrepreneurs and cultural representatives, although sustainability challenges remain. The findings contribute to communication and media studies, particularly in the context of ethnic minority creators in the digital economy.

Keywords: *Facebook content creation, Mon content creators, audience engagement, social media monetization, digital entrepreneurship, creator economy*

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(1) Introduction

1.1 Background of the Study

In recent years, social media has become an essential part of everyday life, transforming the way people communicate, share information, and create economic opportunities. With the rapid development of digital technology and the increasing accessibility of the internet, individuals are now able to participate actively in online platforms. Among various social media platforms, Facebook remains one of the most widely used due to its user-friendly interface, diverse content formats, and strong community features. Initially designed for social networking and communication, Facebook has evolved into a multifunctional platform that supports content creation, business promotion, and digital entrepreneurship.

The rise of the creator economy has further expanded the role of social media platforms. Today, many individuals use Facebook not only for personal expression but also as a professional space to create content and generate income. Through features such as video monetization, live streaming, advertising revenue, and brand collaborations, Facebook enables content creators to transform their creativity and communication skills into financial benefits. As a result, content creation has become a viable career path for many people, particularly young individuals who are familiar with digital technologies.

Within this context, ethnic minority communities have also begun to utilize social media platforms to share their culture, language, and identity. Mon content creators, in particular, have increasingly used Facebook to produce content related to culture, lifestyle, entertainment, education, and social issues. Through their content, they not only entertain audiences but also contribute to the preservation and promotion of Mon cultural identity. Social media provides these creators with opportunities to reach wider audiences, including both Mon and non-Mon viewers, which helps increase cultural awareness and representation in the digital space.

However, despite these opportunities, Mon content creators face several challenges in maintaining content quality, building audiences, and generating stable income. The highly competitive nature of social media platforms means that creators must constantly produce engaging and relevant content to attract and retain followers. In addition, changes in Facebook algorithms can significantly affect content visibility and reach, making it difficult for creators to maintain consistent performance. Technical limitations, financial constraints, and the need for advanced editing tools also present challenges for many creators, particularly those with limited resources.

Furthermore, audience expectations and negative feedback can impact creators' motivation and mental well-being. Content creators often experience pressure to continuously produce new and engaging content, which may lead to stress or burnout. At the same time, income generated through Facebook is not always stable, as it depends on factors such as audience engagement, views, and platform policies. These challenges highlight the complexity of digital content creation as both a creative and economic activity.

Given these circumstances, it is important to understand how Mon content creators navigate the opportunities and challenges associated with Facebook. Examining their content creation practices, audience engagement strategies, and income generation methods can provide valuable insights into the role of social media in supporting minority communities and digital entrepreneurs. This study aims to explore these aspects in order to better understand how Facebook functions as a platform for communication, cultural representation, and economic activity among Mon content creators.

1.2 Significance of the Study

This study is significant because it contributes to the field of communication and media studies by examining how social media platforms support content creation, audience engagement, and income generation. It provides insights into the creator economy, particularly from the perspective of ethnic minority content creators, which is an under-researched area.

In addition, the findings of this study may be useful for aspiring content creators who are interested in developing effective strategies for building audiences and generating income

through social media. The research also highlights the importance of cultural representation in digital spaces, showing how Mon content creators use Facebook to promote their identity and community.

Furthermore, this study may benefit educators, students, and researchers in understanding the practical applications of communication theories in digital environments. It also provides valuable information for social media practitioners and policymakers who aim to create more inclusive and supportive digital platforms.

1.3 Objectives of the Study

This study aims to achieve the following objectives:

- To explore how Mon content creators use Facebook to produce and share digital content.
- To examine the strategies used by Mon content creators to build and engage their audiences.
- To investigate the challenges and opportunities experienced by Mon content creators in generating income through Facebook.

1.4 Research Questions

This study is guided by the following research questions:

1. How do Mon content creators use Facebook to produce and share digital content?
2. What strategies do Mon content creators use to build and engage their audiences on Facebook?
3. What challenges and opportunities do Mon content creators experience in generating income through Facebook?

(2) Literature Review

The rapid development of digital technology and widespread internet access have significantly transformed the landscape of communication, media production, and economic activity. Social media platforms have evolved from simple communication tools into powerful ecosystems that enable individuals to create content, build audiences, and generate income. This transformation has contributed to the emergence of what is widely known as the creator economy, a system in which individuals monetize their creativity, skills, and digital presence through online platforms.

According to the *International Journal of Research in Marketing* (2024), the creator economy has grown into a major global sector supported by digital platforms, technological innovation, and algorithm-driven distribution systems. Content creators are now able to build personal brands, engage audiences, and generate income through various monetization channels. This shift has redefined traditional employment structures by allowing individuals to pursue flexible, independent careers in digital content production. As a result, social media platforms such as Facebook, YouTube, and TikTok have become important spaces for both communication and economic opportunity.

Among these platforms, Facebook remains one of the most widely used and accessible social media platforms globally. It offers diverse content formats, including videos, reels, live streaming, and text-based posts, which allow creators to engage with audiences in multiple ways. In addition, Facebook provides built-in monetization tools that enable content creators to earn income directly from their content. According to Kretschmer et al. (2023), digital platforms like Facebook use revenue-sharing models that allow creators to earn through advertisements, subscriptions, and performance-based incentives. These monetization systems encourage content production while also maintaining platform control over content distribution and visibility.

Content creation on social media can be further understood through the framework of content management and optimization. Content management refers to the planning, organization, production, and scheduling of digital content in a consistent and strategic manner. Effective content management involves setting clear goals, identifying target audiences, and maintaining a regular posting schedule (Chaffey & Ellis-Chadwick, 2019). In addition, content optimization plays a crucial role in increasing visibility and performance. Optimization includes the use of platform features such as hashtags, captions, thumbnails, posting time, and algorithm-friendly

formats such as short-form videos and reels (Tuten & Solomon, 2020). These strategies help improve content reach and engagement. Furthermore, monetization is closely linked to content performance, as higher engagement and visibility often lead to greater income opportunities. Monetization strategies may include advertising revenue, brand sponsorships, affiliate marketing, and platform-based rewards (Kretschmer et al., 2023). Therefore, successful content creators must integrate content creation, management, optimization, and monetization strategies to achieve sustainable growth and income.

Previous studies have identified several key factors that contribute to successful content creation and monetization. One of the most important factors is content consistency. Research suggests that creators who post regularly and maintain a consistent content schedule are more likely to retain audience interest and improve their visibility on platform algorithms (Putra & Santoso, 2024). Consistency helps establish reliability and familiarity, which are essential for building long-term audience relationships.

Another important factor is audience engagement. Audience engagement refers to the level of interaction between creators and their followers, including likes, comments, shares, and direct communication. This concept can be explained through engagement theory, which emphasizes active participation and interaction between communicators and audiences. Engagement is not limited to passive content consumption but includes meaningful interactions that build relationships. According to Brodie et al. (2013), higher levels of engagement lead to increased trust, loyalty, and long-term audience retention. In social media environments, engagement also influences algorithmic visibility, as platforms tend to promote content that generates higher interaction (Tuten & Solomon, 2020). Therefore, creators who actively communicate with their audiences—such as replying to comments, hosting live sessions, and encouraging participation—are more likely to achieve higher reach and engagement.

In addition, content strategy and adaptability play a crucial role in the success of digital content creators. Creators must continuously adapt to changing trends, audience preferences, and platform algorithms. Research shows that successful creators often analyze platform insights and adjust their content strategies based on performance data (Kurniawan & Nugroho, 2025). This includes following trending topics, experimenting with different content formats, and optimizing

posting times. Such strategic behavior allows creators to remain competitive in a highly saturated digital environment.

Persuasive communication is also an important element in content creation. The concept of persuasive appeals is commonly explained through Aristotle's rhetorical theory, which includes three key elements: ethos, pathos, and logos (Aristotle, trans. 2007). Ethos refers to the credibility and trustworthiness of the content creator, which influences audience perception and acceptance of the message. Pathos relates to emotional appeal, where content is designed to evoke feelings such as happiness, empathy, or excitement. Logos refers to logical appeal, which involves presenting clear, factual, and reasonable information. In the context of social media, content creators often use a combination of these persuasive strategies to influence audience engagement and behavior (Perloff, 2017). For example, creators may build trust through authenticity and consistency, create emotional connections through storytelling, and provide informative or educational content. These persuasive elements contribute to audience engagement, content sharing, and monetization success.

Despite these opportunities, content creators face several challenges that affect their ability to sustain audience growth and income generation. One major challenge is the impact of platform algorithms. Algorithm-driven systems determine which content is visible to users, often prioritizing highly engaging or popular content. According to Strauss et al. (2025), these algorithms tend to favor already successful creators, leading to unequal distribution of visibility and income. Smaller or emerging creators may struggle to reach wider audiences, which limits their earning potential and growth opportunities.

Another significant challenge is income instability. Although social media platforms provide monetization opportunities, income from content creation is often unpredictable and inconsistent. Factors such as fluctuating engagement rates, changes in platform policies, and competition can affect earnings. Research highlights that many creators rely on multiple income sources, including sponsorships, brand collaborations, and external business activities, to maintain financial stability (Duffy & Hund, 2024).

Furthermore, competition within the creator economy has intensified as more individuals enter the digital content space. The increasing number of creators leads to content saturation, making it

more difficult for individuals to stand out and attract audiences. As noted by Kurniawan and Nugroho (2025), creators must continuously innovate and differentiate their content to remain competitive. This often requires additional time, effort, and resources, which can lead to stress and burnout.

In addition to technical and economic challenges, content creators also face psychological and social pressures. The need to maintain consistent output, respond to audience expectations, and handle negative feedback can affect creators' mental well-being. Duffy and Hund (2024) emphasize that creators often experience emotional labor as they balance authenticity with audience engagement. Negative comments, public criticism, and online harassment can reduce motivation and impact content quality.

Another important aspect of social media content creation is authenticity and trust. Maintaining audience trust is essential for long-term success in the creator economy. Research shows that audiences are more likely to engage with content that appears genuine and relatable (Duffy & Hund, 2024). However, excessive commercialization or sponsorship may reduce perceived authenticity, leading to decreased audience engagement. Therefore, creators must balance income-generating activities with authentic communication to maintain credibility.

While many studies have explored content creation and monetization in general, there is limited research focusing on ethnic minority content creators, particularly in Southeast Asia. Social media platforms provide unique opportunities for minority communities to represent their culture, language, and identity in digital spaces. Mon content creators, for example, use Facebook to produce content related to culture, lifestyle, education, and social issues, contributing to cultural preservation and community awareness.

However, minority creators may face additional challenges, including language barriers, limited access to monetization programs, and smaller audience reach. These factors can affect their ability to compete with mainstream creators and achieve financial success. At the same time, social media offers opportunities for minority creators to gain visibility, strengthen cultural identity, and connect with broader audiences.

In summary, existing literature highlights that social media platforms, particularly Facebook, provide significant opportunities for content creators to build audiences and generate income. Key success factors include consistent content production, strong audience engagement, effective content strategies, and the use of persuasive communication techniques. However, creators also face multiple challenges, including algorithm changes, income instability, competition, and psychological pressure. While previous research provides valuable insights into the creator economy, there is a gap in understanding the experiences of specific cultural groups, such as Mon content creators. Therefore, this study aims to explore how Mon content creators use Facebook for content creation, audience building, and income generation, as well as the challenges and opportunities they encounter in the digital environment.

(3) Theoretical Framework

This study is guided by a conceptual framework that explains the relationship between **content creation practices**, **audience-building strategies**, **earning income**, and the **challenges and opportunities** experienced by Mon content creators on Facebook.

In this framework, **content creation practices** are considered the starting point of the process. These include the type of content produced, language use, and communication style. Effective content creation plays a crucial role in attracting and retaining audiences on Facebook.

Next, **audience-building strategies** act as a mediating factor between content creation and income generation. Audience-building strategies include interaction with followers, responding to comments, and engagement techniques such as likes, shares, and reactions. Strong audience engagement helps increase visibility and reach on Facebook.

Earning income is viewed as the outcome of successful content creation and audience-building activities. Income generation may occur through Facebook monetization programs.

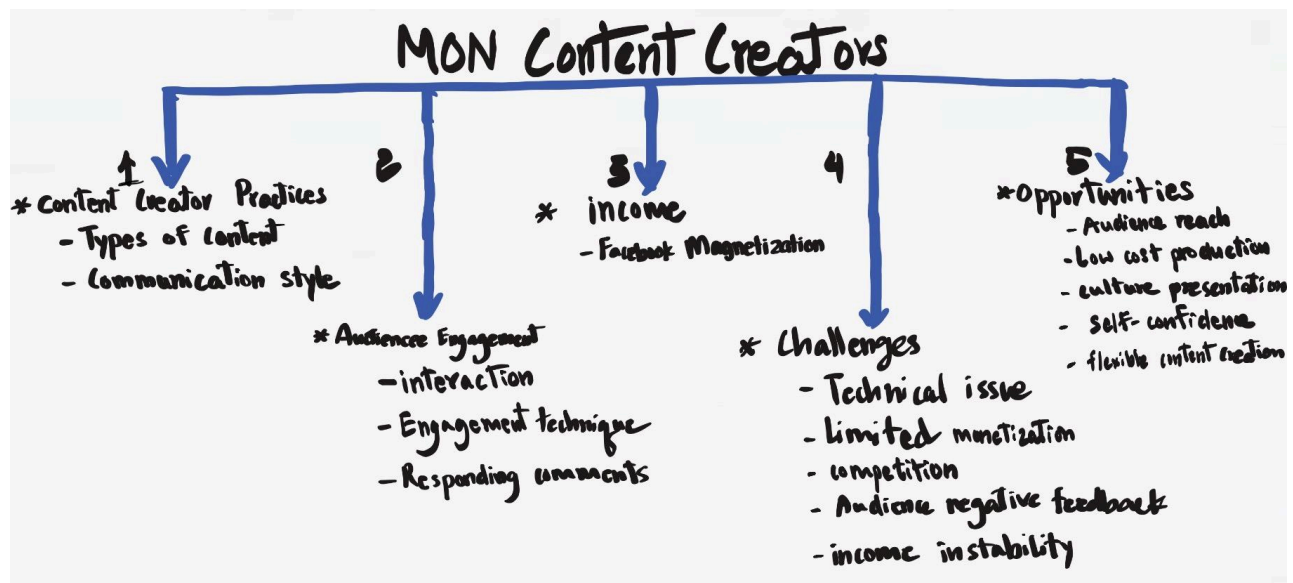
However, the relationship between these elements is influenced by **challenges and opportunities**, which act as moderating factors. Challenges may include algorithm changes, competition, limited monetization access, technical issues, and content fatigue. Opportunities

include wide audience reach, low-cost content production, cultural representation, and flexible income opportunities provided by Facebook.

Content Creation Practices → Audience Building & Engagement → Income Generation

(Challenges and Opportunities influence all stages of the process)

For this study, this framework is suitable because it clearly shows how communication practices on Facebook contribute to audience growth and income generation among Mon content creators. It also highlights the role of external factors that affect creators' success, making it appropriate for studies in **communication, media, and digital content creation**.



(4) Methodology

This study employs a **mixed-method research design** to explore how Mon content creators use Facebook for content creation, audience engagement, and income generation, as well as to examine the challenges and opportunities they experience. The mixed-method approach combines both quantitative and qualitative data to provide a comprehensive understanding of the

research problem. The quantitative component offers generalizable patterns through survey data, while the qualitative component provides in-depth insights into participants' experiences.

4.1 Research Design

A mixed-method design was selected because it allows the researcher to examine both statistical trends and personal perspectives. The quantitative data were collected through structured questionnaires to identify common practices, strategies, and perceptions among Mon content creators. Meanwhile, qualitative data were obtained through semi-structured interviews to explore participants' experiences in greater depth. This combination strengthens the validity of the findings by triangulating data from multiple sources.

4.2 Population and Sample

The target population of this study consists of Mon content creators who actively use Facebook as their primary platform for content creation and income generation. The sample includes **30 Mon content creators** who meet specific criteria. These criteria are: (1) they identify as Mon content creators, (2) they have at least 5,000 followers on their Facebook page or profile, (3) they are currently earning income through Facebook monetization features or related activities, and (4) they are actively producing and posting content.

This study uses **purposive sampling**, a non-probability sampling technique, to select participants who have relevant experience and knowledge related to the research topic. Purposive sampling is appropriate for this study because it focuses on individuals who can provide meaningful and specific information about Facebook content creation and monetization.

In addition to the survey participants, **three content creators** (two males and one female) were selected for in-depth interviews. These participants were chosen based on their willingness to participate and their active engagement in content creation.

4.3 Research Instruments

This study utilizes two main research instruments: a structured questionnaire and a semi-structured interview guide.

For the quantitative component, a **structured questionnaire** was developed and distributed through Google Forms. The questionnaire consists of several sections. The first section collects demographic information such as gender, age, years of content creation experience, type of content produced, and number of followers. The second section focuses on content creation practices and audience engagement strategies, using Likert-scale items ranging from “strongly disagree” to “strongly agree.” The third section examines income generation, opportunities, and challenges experienced by the participants. The questionnaire also includes open-ended questions to allow respondents to share additional insights.

For the qualitative component, a **semi-structured interview guide** was used. The interview questions were designed to align with the research objectives and research questions. The semi-structured format allows flexibility for participants to elaborate on their experiences while ensuring that key topics such as content strategies, audience engagement, monetization practices, challenges, and opportunities are covered.

4.4 Data Collection Procedure

Data collection was conducted over a one-week period. The questionnaire was distributed online via Google Forms to the selected participants. Respondents were informed about the purpose of the study, and their participation was voluntary. They were also assured that their responses would remain anonymous and confidential.

For the qualitative part, interviews were conducted with three selected participants. The interviews were carried out through online communication platforms and were recorded with the participants’ consent. Each interview lasted approximately 20–30 minutes.

4.5 Data Analysis

The quantitative data collected from the questionnaires were analyzed using descriptive statistics, including percentages and frequency distributions. These statistical methods were used to identify patterns in content creation practices, audience engagement strategies, income generation, and perceived challenges and opportunities. The results were presented using tables and pie charts to enhance clarity and interpretation.

The qualitative data from the interviews were analyzed using thematic analysis. The researcher identified key themes and patterns related to participants' experiences, strategies, challenges, and perceptions. Selected quotes from the interviews were included in the findings to support and enrich the quantitative results.

4.6 Ethical Considerations

This study follows ethical research principles to ensure the protection of participants. Participation in the study was voluntary, and respondents had the right to withdraw at any time. All responses were kept anonymous and confidential, and the data were used solely for academic purposes as part of the IEC-491 Independent Study at Payap University. Informed consent was obtained from all participants before data collection.

(5) Findings

This section presents the findings of the study based on data collected from 30 Mon content creators through questionnaires and three in-depth interviews. The findings are organized according to the three main research objectives: (1) content creation practices, (2) audience building and engagement strategies, and (3) challenges and opportunities in income generation. Both quantitative and qualitative results are integrated to provide a comprehensive understanding of the experiences of Mon content creators on Facebook.

5.1 Content Creation Practices of Mon Content Creators

The findings show that Mon content creators actively use Facebook as a platform to produce and share various types of content, including entertainment, lifestyle, education, and cultural content. Among the respondents, **40% identified lifestyle as their main content type**, followed by **23.3% Entertainment content**, **20% educational content**, and **10% cultural or social issue-related content**.

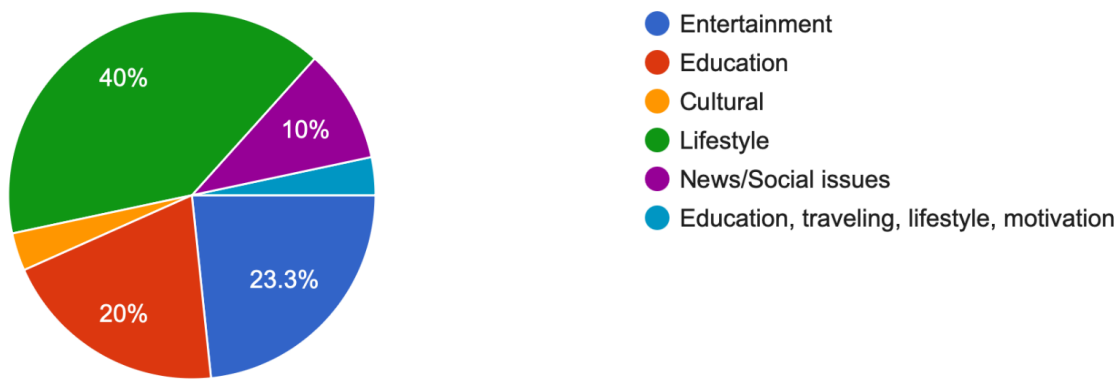


Figure 1 “Types of Content Created”

In terms of experience, the majority of respondents (**63.3%**) have been creating content for **1–2 years**, while **13.3%** have **less than one year of experience**, and the remaining **23.3%** have **3–4 years of experience**. This indicates that most Mon content creators are relatively new but actively engaged in digital content production.

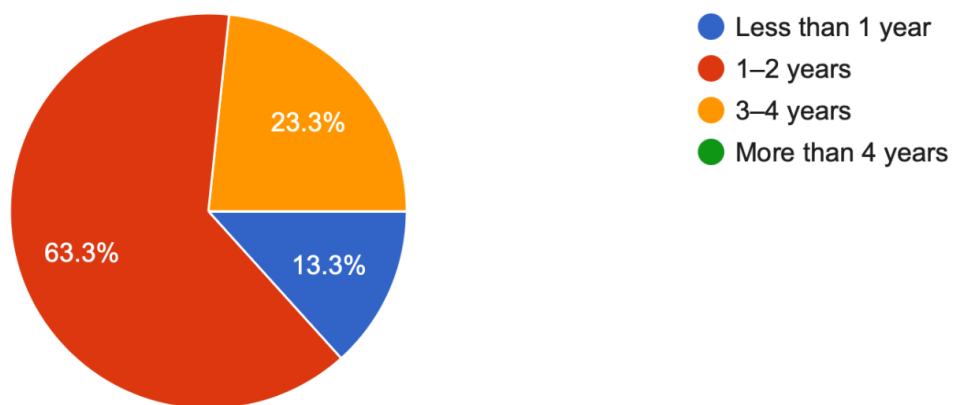


Figure 2 “Years of Content Creation Experience”

The findings also reveal that content creators demonstrate strong planning and strategic behavior. Specifically, **83% of respondents agreed or strongly agreed that they plan their content before posting**, indicating a structured approach to content creation. Additionally, **87% reported following trending topics** to increase reach, suggesting that creators are aware of platform dynamics and audience preferences.

Moreover, cultural representation plays an important role. Approximately **70% of respondents agreed that they create content promoting Mon culture and identity**, highlighting the role of social media in preserving and sharing cultural values. At the same time, **80% of creators reported using multiple languages (Mon, Burmese, and/or English)** to reach a wider audience.

Interview findings further support these results. One participant explained:

“I try to plan my content before posting, especially to make sure it is interesting and relevant to my audience. Sometimes I follow trends, but I also want to include Mon culture in my videos.”

This suggests that creators balance trending content with cultural identity, aligning with both audience demand and cultural representation.

In addition, **76% of respondents indicated that they maintain a consistent posting schedule**, demonstrating commitment and discipline in content production. However, some interview participants mentioned that maintaining consistency can be difficult due to time constraints and other responsibilities.

5.2 Audience Building and Engagement Strategies

The findings indicate that audience engagement is a central factor in content creation. A high percentage of respondents (**90%**) agreed that engagement (likes, shares, and comments) is important for increasing visibility on Facebook.

Furthermore, **86% of respondents reported actively replying to comments and messages**, showing strong interaction between creators and their audiences. This suggests that creators prioritize building relationships with their followers.

Additionally, **73% of respondents agreed that audience loyalty is more important than follower numbers**, indicating that creators value meaningful engagement over quantity. This aligns with the idea that strong audience relationships contribute to long-term success.

The use of platform tools also plays a role in engagement strategies. Approximately **65% of respondents reported using Facebook Live**, while **70% collaborate with other creators** to expand their audience reach. These strategies help increase visibility and diversify content.

Moreover, **78% of respondents reported analyzing Facebook insights** to improve their content performance. This demonstrates that creators are using data-driven approaches to refine their strategies.

Interview participants emphasized the importance of audience interaction. One respondent stated:

“Replying to comments and messages helps me connect with my audience. If I don’t interact, they may lose interest.”

Another participant added:

“Collaboration with other creators helps me gain more followers because we can share audiences.”

These responses highlight that engagement strategies are not only technical but also relational, focusing on communication and trust-building.

5.3 Income Generation and Monetization

The findings reveal that Facebook serves as a potential source of income for Mon content creators, although income levels vary. Approximately **60% of respondents agreed that Facebook is a source of income**, but only **35% strongly agreed that it is their main source of income**.

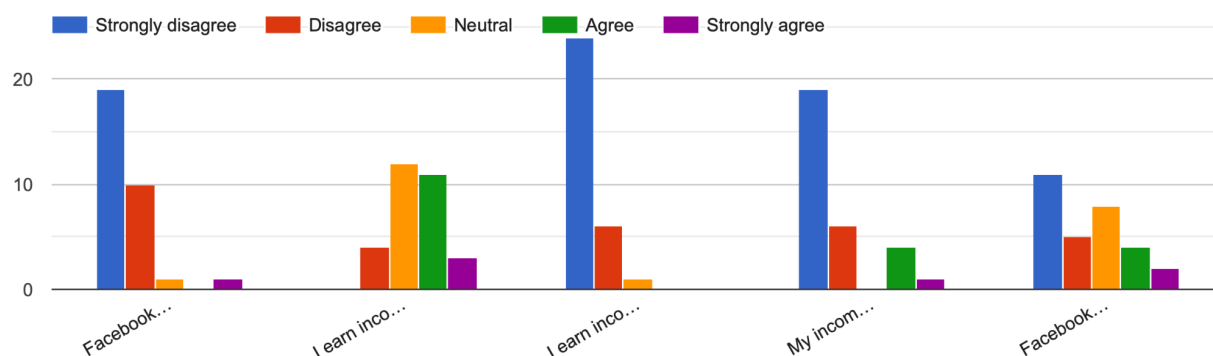


Figure 3 “Facebook as a Source of Income”

In terms of monetization methods, **75% of respondents reported earning income through Facebook monetization tools**, such as ads, stars, and live gifts. Additionally, **68% earn income through brand sponsorships**, indicating that creators rely on multiple income streams.

However, income stability remains a concern. Only **30% of respondents agreed that their income is stable**, while **50% disagreed or remained neutral**, suggesting uncertainty in earnings.

Interview findings support this issue. One participant stated:

“Sometimes I earn money, but it is not stable. It depends on views and engagement.”

Another participant explained:

“I can earn extra income from Facebook, but it is not enough to rely on fully.”

These findings indicate that while Facebook provides income opportunities, it does not guarantee financial security.

5.4 Challenges Faced by Mon Content Creators

The study identifies several key challenges affecting Mon content creators. One of the most significant challenges is **algorithm changes**, with **82% of respondents agreeing that algorithm changes negatively affect their reach and income**.

Competition is another major challenge. Approximately **78% of respondents agreed that competition from other creators makes earning income difficult**, reflecting the increasing saturation of the content creation space.

Technical and financial barriers also play a role. Around **70% of respondents reported that internet or technical problems affect their content production**, while **75% identified the cost of equipment and paid editing applications as a challenge**.

Time constraints are also significant. A high percentage (**85%**) agreed that content creation requires a large amount of time for planning, filming, and editing. Additionally, **72% reported feeling pressure to continuously create new content**, and **68% experienced stress or burnout**.

Interview participants provided deeper insights into these challenges. One respondent explained:

“Creating content takes a lot of time, especially editing. Some apps require payment, which is difficult for me.”

Another participant highlighted social challenges:

“Sometimes people criticize my content, and it affects my motivation.”

These findings show that challenges are not only technical and financial but also psychological and social.

5.5 Opportunities and Perceptions of Content Creation

Despite the challenges, the findings reveal several important opportunities for Mon content creators. A large majority (**88%**) agreed that Facebook provides increased visibility for Mon creators in society.

Cultural impact is also significant. Approximately **85% of respondents agreed that content creation helps strengthen Mon community identity**, demonstrating the cultural value of digital media.

In terms of personal development, **82% reported that content creation improves professional skills**, such as communication, marketing, and video editing. Additionally, **80% stated that content creation increases their self-confidence**.

Financial opportunities are also evident. Around **77% of respondents agreed that content creation allows them to earn additional income**, even if it is not always stable.

Interview participants emphasized these benefits. One respondent shared:

“I gained more confidence and improved my skills through content creation.”

Another participant noted:

“Facebook helps people know me, and I can connect with others and sometimes earn money.”

These responses highlight that content creation provides both economic and personal benefits.

5.6 Ethical Awareness and Content Practices

The findings also show that ethical awareness is relatively high among Mon content creators. Approximately **80% of respondents agreed that they primarily create original content**, while **65% reported occasionally using reaction or shared content**.

In addition, **85% of respondents indicated that they are aware of ethical guidelines**, including copyright and responsible communication. Furthermore, **88% agreed that following ethical standards is important for maintaining audience trust and long-term income sustainability**.

These results suggest that most creators understand the importance of ethical practices in digital content creation.

Overall, the findings demonstrate that Mon content creators actively use Facebook for content production, audience engagement, and income generation. While creators employ strategic practices such as content planning, audience interaction, and trend adaptation, they also face

significant challenges related to algorithms, competition, financial costs, and time constraints. Despite these challenges, Facebook provides valuable opportunities for cultural representation, skill development, social influence, and additional income. The integration of survey and interview findings highlights both the quantitative trends and the personal experiences of creators, providing a comprehensive understanding of the research topic.

(6) Discussion and Conclusion

6.1 Discussion

This study aimed to examine how Mon content creators use Facebook for content creation, audience building, and income generation, as well as the challenges and opportunities they experience. The findings reveal that Mon content creators actively engage in strategic content production, audience interaction, and monetization practices, which are consistent with existing research on the creator economy.

First, in terms of content creation practices, the findings show that a high percentage of creators plan their content, follow trends, and maintain consistent posting schedules. This supports the study by Putra and Santoso (2024), which emphasizes that consistent content production and strategic planning are key factors for success in digital content creation. Additionally, the integration of Mon cultural elements into content highlights the role of social media as a platform for cultural representation. This finding contributes to the existing literature by showing how minority creators use digital platforms not only for economic purposes but also for cultural preservation and identity promotion.

Second, audience engagement emerged as a critical factor influencing content visibility and success. The majority of respondents actively interact with their audience by replying to comments, using Facebook Live, and collaborating with other creators. These findings align with previous studies indicating that audience engagement enhances visibility through algorithmic systems (Kurniawan & Nugroho, 2025). Moreover, the preference for audience loyalty over follower numbers suggests that creators value meaningful relationships with their audience,

which supports Duffy and Hund's (2024) argument that trust and authenticity are essential for sustaining audience engagement.

Third, regarding income generation, the findings indicate that while Facebook provides monetization opportunities, income is often unstable and unpredictable. Although many creators earn through monetization tools and sponsorships, only a small percentage consider Facebook their primary and stable source of income. This supports Strauss et al. (2025), who found that algorithm-driven platforms often create unequal income distribution, favoring more popular creators. The findings suggest that Mon content creators face similar financial uncertainties, highlighting the limitations of relying solely on social media for income.

Furthermore, the study identifies several significant challenges faced by Mon content creators. Algorithm changes, competition, and technical limitations were reported as major obstacles. These findings are consistent with previous research, which indicates that platform algorithms and competition create barriers for content visibility and growth (Kretschmer et al., 2023). Additionally, time constraints, content pressure, and burnout reflect the emotional and psychological challenges discussed by Duffy and Hund (2024), who emphasize the demanding nature of digital content creation.

Despite these challenges, the study also highlights important opportunities. Facebook provides a platform for increased visibility, skill development, and additional income. The findings show that content creation enhances professional skills, self-confidence, and social influence, supporting the idea that the creator economy offers both economic and personal development opportunities (International Journal of Research in Marketing, 2024). Moreover, the role of content creation in strengthening Mon cultural identity demonstrates the broader social and cultural impact of digital media.

Based on the findings of this study, several recommendations can be made for Mon content creators, educators, and future researchers. First, Mon content creators should focus on developing consistent content strategies and improving audience engagement by actively interacting with followers, responding to comments, and utilizing features such as live streaming and collaborations. Enhancing digital skills, particularly in video editing, content planning, and data analysis, can help creators improve content quality and performance.

Second, creators are encouraged to diversify their income sources instead of relying solely on Facebook monetization. Exploring brand partnerships, cross-platform content sharing, and other digital opportunities may help increase income stability. In addition, managing time effectively and maintaining a balance between content creation and personal well-being is important to reduce stress and prevent burnout.

For educators and institutions, it is recommended to provide training programs or workshops on digital content creation, social media marketing, and ethical practices. Such support can help aspiring creators develop professional skills and adapt to the evolving digital environment.

Future research should expand the sample size and include other social media platforms such as YouTube or TikTok to provide a broader understanding of the creator economy. Further studies may also explore audience perspectives or conduct longitudinal research to examine long-term trends in content creation and monetization.

All in all, this data shows that Mon content creators are actively navigating the opportunities and challenges of the digital creator economy. While their practices align with global trends in content creation and monetization, their experiences also highlight unique aspects related to cultural representation and minority identity. The findings confirm that Facebook serves as both an enabling platform and a challenging environment, requiring creators to continuously adapt their strategies to achieve sustainable success.

6.2 Conclusion

This study examined how Mon content creators use Facebook for content creation, audience building, and income generation, as well as the challenges and opportunities they experience. The findings demonstrate that Facebook plays a significant role as a digital platform that supports both communication and economic activities among Mon content creators.

The study found that Mon creators actively engage in structured content creation practices, including planning content, following trends, and maintaining consistency. These practices contribute to audience growth and visibility on the platform. In addition, audience engagement

strategies such as replying to comments, using Facebook Live, and collaborating with other creators are essential for building strong relationships with followers. The results highlight that audience loyalty and interaction are more important than simply increasing follower numbers.

In terms of income generation, the findings show that Facebook provides multiple opportunities for earning, including monetization tools and brand sponsorships. However, income is often unstable and cannot be fully relied upon as a primary source of income. This indicates that while Facebook offers financial opportunities, it does not guarantee long-term economic security for content creators.

The study also identified several challenges, including algorithm changes, competition, technical issues, time constraints, and psychological pressures such as stress and burnout. These challenges affect creators' ability to sustain content production and income generation. Despite these difficulties, the study highlights important opportunities, such as increased social visibility, skill development, cultural promotion, and additional income.

Overall, this study concludes that Facebook serves as both an opportunity and a challenge for Mon content creators. While it enables creators to express their identity, build audiences, and earn income, it also requires continuous adaptation and effort. The findings contribute to a better understanding of digital content creation among minority communities and highlight the importance of supporting sustainable practices in the creator economy.

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